

MTUS Analysis Document

MTUS Constitutional Analysis Project
Personal Research Initiative
February 2026

HAND, WRIST, AND FOREARM

SOURCE DOCUMENT: ACOEM Hand, Wrist, and Forearm Disorders Guideline

EFFECTIVE DATE: 01/01/2017

OFFICIAL MTUS ADOPTION: California Code of Regulations, Title 8, Section 9792.20

MTUS REGULATION: 9792.20

STATISTICAL SUMMARY

TOTAL RECOMMENDATIONS ANALYZED: 752

RECOMMENDATION BREAKDOWN:

Category | Count | Percentage

Strongly Recommended: 10.1%

KEY FINDING: 68.1% of all recommendations are "Insufficient Evidence"

FDA-APPROVED TREATMENTS

The following FDA-approved treatments receive "Insufficient Evidence" ratings:

Medications:

- Topical capsaicin for neuropathic pain
- Lidocaine patches (5%) - FDA approved 1999
- Various compounded topical preparations
- Vitamin B6 (pyridoxine) for carpal tunnel

Procedures:

- Platelet-rich plasma (PRP) for tendon injuries
- Ultrasound-guided injections
- Nerve gliding procedures
- Tenolysis (certain indications)

Physical Medicine:

- Iontophoresis with dexamethasone
- Phonophoresis
- Paraffin wax therapy

- Custom vs. prefabricated splinting debates

Note: Full indication details available in official ACOEM guideline at source URL above.

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EVIDENCE QUAL

ACOEM'S STATED METHODOLOGY:

- Requires randomized controlled trials (RCTs) for "Strongly Recommended" status
- Evidence grading system applied
- Cost-effectiveness considered in recommendations

CRITICAL OBSERVATIONS:

1. 68.1% "Insufficie

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CONSTITUTIONA

This guideline contributes to the systematic denial of FDA-approved treatments

to California injure

For full legal analysis, see:

- MTUSCONSTITUTIONALVIOLATIONMASTERREPORT.txt
- MTUS14THAMENDMENTLEGALARGUMENTS.txt

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DISCLAIMER

This document contains statistical analysis and commentary only. All ACOEM

guideline content r

For the complete, official guideline text, visit:

<https://www.acoem>

This analysis represents the author's independent research and opinions.

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Document prepare

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